

74 Reporting simple questions

Simple questions can be answered with “yes” and “no.” English uses “if” and “whether” to report simple questions.

⚙️ **New language** “If” and “whether”

Aa **Vocabulary** Verb + preposition collocations

🧩 **New skill** Reporting simple questions

74.1 KEY LANGUAGE “IF” AND “WHETHER”

If the answer to a question in direct speech is “yes” or “no,” use “if” or “whether” to report the question. “Whether” is more formal than “if.”



Direct question can be answered with “yes” or “no.”

Are you meeting your sales targets?

My boss asked me **if I was** meeting my sales targets.

Reported question uses “if” or “whether.”



74.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES “IF” AND “WHETHER”



Will you be at the meeting on Monday?



Kara asked **whether I would** be at the meeting on Monday.

In reported questions with “if” and “whether,” you can leave out the object after “asked.”



Do you want to stay for dinner?

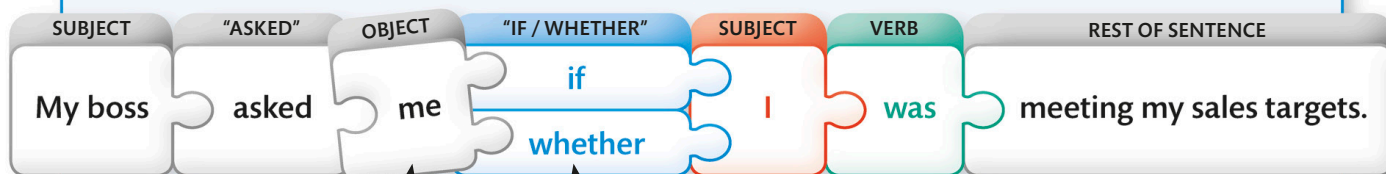


Ian asked me **if we wanted** to stay for dinner.

Reported questions with “if” and “whether” leave out the auxiliary verb “do.”



74.3 HOW TO FORM REPORTED QUESTIONS WITH “IF” AND “WHETHER”



You can leave the object out.

“If” and “whether” mean the same thing, but “whether” is more formal.